Stage	Caller	Git posture	Issue gates
operator-preflight	maintainer before release prep	Clean local main exactly matches origin/main.	Optional visibility check.
prep-pr	release-prep branch	Branch-local validation after version/docs changes; does not require HEAD == origin/main.	Report target milestone state in the PR.
final-local	maintainer after merge	Local main exactly matches origin/main; final tag target is fixed.	Enforced live.
tag-workflow	tag push workflow	Tag commit must be the release commit on origin/main.	Policy target; current workflows do not enforce ancestry.
rerun-workflow	manual workflow dispatch for an existing tag	Existing tag must remain reachable from origin/main.	Skipped for registry recovery; do not move the tag.